

a bit eccentric. He just loved talking about the markets. He really brought the markets to life for me. Also, I wanted to make money.

Was it the money that appealed to you in the movie *Wall Street*?

It was more the action that appealed to me. I'm a high-energy guy. I thought that trading perfectly fit my personality. My desire to make money was more influenced by my parents being immigrants who worked very hard. Those were my key influences. There wasn't much more to it. After college, all my friends went into banking, but I knew I wanted to be a trader. Even though I didn't know exactly what it was, I knew it was what I wanted to do. I interviewed with some larger firms like UBS and Société Générale, and then one of my friends told me about a small firm called First New York Securities. I interviewed there and Don Ehrenberg hired me.

Do you know what got you the job?

I don't know what got me the job, but several years after I had started with the firm, I brought my mother in to meet Don. In their sit-down conversation, Don told her, "I don't know what you did to your son, but I never had anybody work so hard." I knew I wanted it more than anybody else. There was no way I was not going to make it. I always had that competitive drive, whether it was getting into a top college, or competing in college sports.

What did you learn about trading at First New York Securities?

I was an assistant for a year; same as Zach is. I learned how to follow positions and a daily P&L. I was fascinated by how the stock market moved and how money was being made.

What was the trading style of the trader you worked for?

Eric had a style similar to the style I have: Buy companies when they are out of favor and sell companies when everybody loves them.

It sounds like you came into this business as a contrarian.

I was introduced to that style of trading very early on, and it made complete sense with the way I looked at the world. Fidelity and the other behemoths that run massive amounts of public money are only buying